

Unit I - Introduction To Value Education

Topic: Understanding Value Education

Character oriented education that instills basic values and ethnic values in one's psyche is called '**value based education**'.

One definition refers to it as the process that gives young people an initiation into values, giving knowledge of the rules needed to function in this mode of relating to other people, and to seek the development in the student a grasp of certain underlying principles, together with the ability to apply these rules intelligently, and to have the settled disposition to do so.

Significance of Value Education

- Value education is important to help everyone in improving the value system that he/she holds and puts it to use.
- Once, one has understood his/ her values in life he/she can examine and control the various choices he/she makes in his/ her life.
- One has to frequently uphold the various types of values in his/ her life such as cultural values, universal values, personal values and social values.
- Value education is always essential to shape one's life and to give one an opportunity of performing on the global stage.

The need for value education among the parents, children, teachers etc, is constantly increasing as we continue to witness increasing violent activities, behavioral disorders and lack of unity in the society etc.

Value education enables us to understand our needs and visualize our goals correctly and also indicate the direction for their fulfillment. It also helps remove our confusions and contradictions and enables us to rightly utilize the technological innovations.

Human Values:

- Human values are a set of emotional rules; people follow to make the right decisions in life.
- **When values are used in a professional setting, they are called ethics.**
- Values are used in every day decision making at work and at home.
- Good values instill a sense of integrity, honesty and diligence in people.
- Without good values, people would become corrupt, dishonest and undependable as people and employees.

Cultural Values:

- Groups, societies and cultures have values that are largely shared by their members.
- The values identify those objects, conditions or characteristics that members of the society consider important; that is, valuable.
- In the western world, **for example**, values might include material comfort, wealth, competition, individualism or religiosity.

- The values of a society can often be identified by noting which people receive honour or respect.
- In the US, for example, professional athletes at the top levels in some sports are honored (in the form of monetary payment) more than college professors.
- Values are related to the norms of a culture, but they are more general and abstract than norms. **Norms are rules for behavior in specific situations, while values identify what should be judged as good or evil.**
 - Example: Flying the **national flag on 15th August** in India is a norm, but it reflects the **value of patriotism**.
 - Wearing dark clothing and appearing solemn are normative behaviours at the funeral. They reflect the values of respect and support of friends and family.
- Different cultures reflect different values. “Over the last three decades, traditional-age college students have shown **an increased interest in personal well-being** and a **decreased interest in the welfare of others.**” Values seem to have changed, affecting the beliefs, and attitudes of college students.

Purpose of Value Education

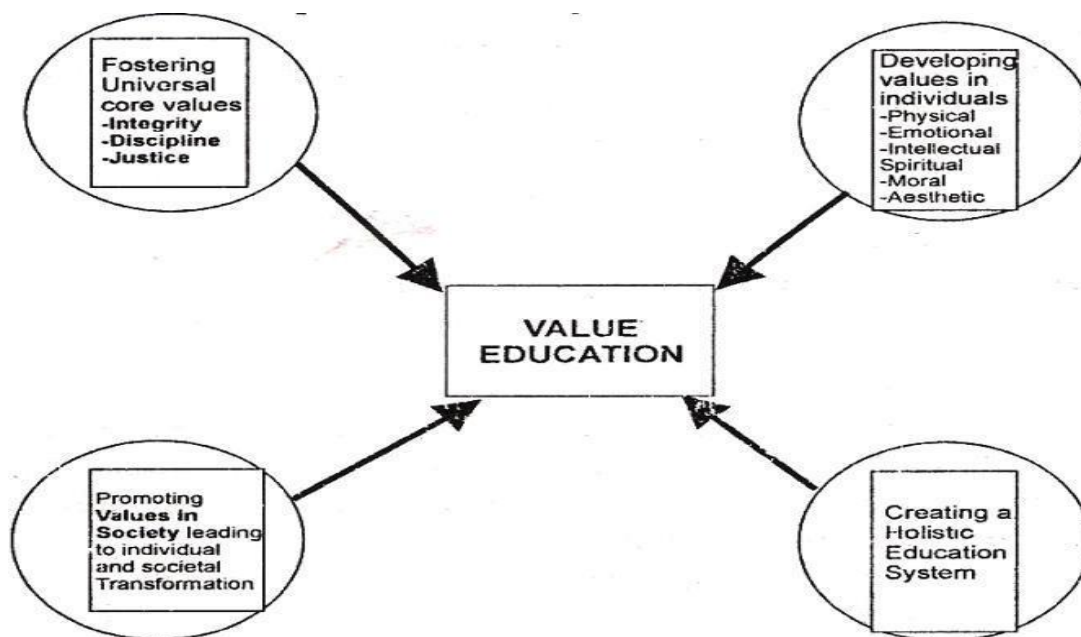


Fig. 1.1. The Purpose Of Value Education

The Role of Value Education:

Value education plays a very important role in creating a better society, more ethical organizations and groups, and better human beings as:

1. Value education can help to **build human beings who possess strength, integrity and fortitude** based upon ancient Indian values.
2. Value education builds the **values of cooperation and peace as well as tolerance**.
3. **Efficiency can step up** if a person possesses the right values. This may **include punctuality, keeping one's word, professionalism, lack of bias or prejudice** etc.

4. Creating **cordial relationships** between people by encouraging the values of respect, love and affection.
5. **Promoting personality** development and social cohesion.
6. Regeneration values of national pride and integration towards **nation- building**.
7. **Building character** in the young people who will lead the country in the future.
8. **Inculcate moral and spiritual values** in the minds of students and making them aware of the teachings of Great Men so that they may learn from their examples.
9. **Promoting harmony** between nations and creating a peaceful world order.
10. Identifying the core universal values of:
 - a. Truth (Satya)
 - b. Righteous Conduct (Dharma)
 - c. Peace (Shanti)
 - d. Love (Prema)
 - e. Non-Violence (Ahimsa)
11. To help create a foundation of the **quality of life** and strike a balance between external and internal values.

Thus value education can play a significant role in the betterment of individuals, groups and society at large. This is shown in the figure below:

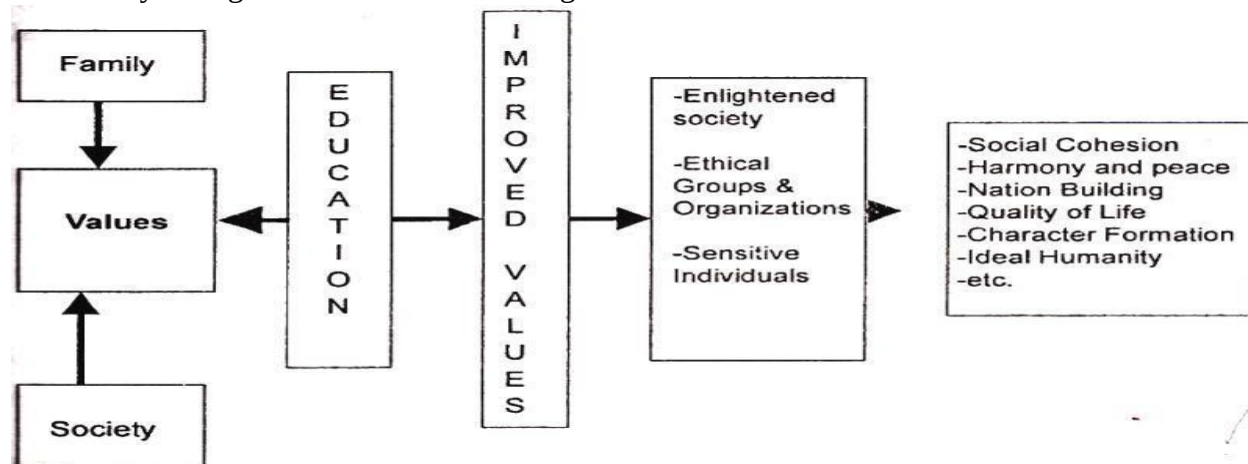


Fig. 1.3 Education As an Input to Improved Values

Need of Value Education

- **Correct identification of our aspirations.** The subject which enables us to understand ‘what is valuable’ for human happiness is called ‘value education’ (VE). Thus, VE enables us to **understand our needs and visualize our goals correctly** and also indicate the direction for their fulfillment. It also **helps to remove our confusions** and contradictions and bring harmony at all levels.
- **Understanding universal human values to fulfill our aspirations in continuity.** All human beings continuously aspire for a happy life, successful life, and the purpose of education is to provide adequate competence to actualize this aspiration.
- **Complementarity of values and skills.** For this it is essential to understand – what is really ‘valuable’ for human being, and what is really conducive to a happy and fulfilling life? - This is the ‘value domain’.

Then one should know – how to actualize it? How to make it happen? – This is the ‘domain of skills’.

Hence, there is an essential complementarity between values and skills for the success of any human endeavor.

For example, I want to lead a healthy life. Only wishing for good health will not help me keep my body fit and healthy and without having understood the meaning of health, I will not be able to choose things correctly to keep my body fit and healthy.

- **Evaluation of our beliefs.** Each one of us believes in certain things and we base our values on these beliefs, are they false or true which may or may not be true in reality. VE helps us to evaluate our beliefs and assumed values.
- **Technology and human values.** The present education system has become largely **skill-based**. The prime emphasis is on science and technology. However, science and technology can only help to provide the means to achieve what is considered valuable. It is not within the scope of science and technology to provide the competence of deciding what really is valuable.
- VE is a crucial missing link in the present education system. Because of this deficiency, most of our efforts may prove to be counter-productive and serious crises at the individual, societal and environmental level are manifesting.

Hence, there is a strong need to rectify this situation

Basic Guidelines for Value Education

In order to qualify for any course on value education, the following guidelines for the content of the course are important:

- **Universal:** It needs to be applicable to all the human beings irrespective of cast, creed, nationalities, religion, etc., for all times and regions.
- **Rational:** It has to appeal to human reasoning.
- **Natural and verifiable:** It has to be naturally acceptable to the human being who goes through the course and there needs to be every provision in nature for its fulfillment. It needs to be experientially verifiable, and not based on dogmas, beliefs or assumptions.
- **All encompassing:** It needs to cover all the dimensions (thought, behavior, work and realization) and levels (individual, family, society, nature and existence) of human life and profession.
- **Leading to harmony:** The value education ultimately is targeted to promote harmony within the individual, among human beings and with nature.

Types of Values

- Life comes with its ups and downs. Yes, we all know that. But there are certain mindsets that affect our life for the better and some that affect it for the worst. These **mindsets that affect our life for the better can be called as values**.
- Whilst it stands true that all people have different values in life, there are some important values in life that should be considered by all. Not because these are the values that we follow, but because it could truly make this world a better place.

Most Important Core values in life:

- **Love :** Unconditional & unselfish care
- **Discipline/truth/honesty:** Indispensable ethical discipline
- **Non Violence:** Means respect for life and recognition for rights for others
- **Right conduct:** Truth in action is right conduct

“Thinking with love is truth, feeling with love is peace, acting with love is right conduct, and understanding with love is non-violence”

Process of Value Education

- The process for value education has to be that of self-exploration, and not of giving sermons of telling dos and don'ts. Whatever is found as truth or reality may be stated as a proposal and every student is to be encouraged to verify it on his/ her own right.
- This process of self-exploration has to be in the form of a dialogue- a dialogue between the teacher and students to begin with and within the student finally.

Topic : Self Exploration

Self exploration is the process to find out what is valuable to me by investigating within myself, what is right for me, true for me, has to be judged within myself. Through self exploration we get value of myself.

Meaning and Purpose of Self Exploration:-

1. **It is a process of dialogue between “what you are” and “what you really want to be”:** It is a process of **focusing attention on our-self, our present beliefs and aspirations** vis-à-vis what we really want to be (that is to say, what is naturally acceptable to us). It is a process of discovering that there is something innate, invariant and universal in all human beings. This enables us to look at our confusions and contradictions within and resolve them by becoming aware of our natural acceptance.
2. **It is a process of self-evaluation through self investigation:** It successively enables us to evolve by bridging the gap between ‘what we are’ and ‘what to be’.
3. **It is a process of knowing oneself and through that, knowing the entire existence:** The exploration starts by asking simple questions about ourself, which gives our clarity about our being, and then clarity about everything around us.
4. **It is a process of recognizing one’s relationship with every unit in existence and fulfilling it:** It is a process of becoming aware about our right relationship with other entities in existence and through that discovering the interconnectedness, co-existence and other in the entire existence, and living accordingly.
5. **It is a process of knowing human conduct, human character and living accordingly:** It is a process of discovering the definitiveness of human conduct and human character and enabling one to be definite in thought, behavior and work.
6. **It is a process of being in harmony in oneself and in harmony with entire existence:** This process of self exploration helps us to be in harmony with ourself and with everything around.

7. **It is a process of identifying our innateness and moving towards self organization and self-expression:** This process of self exploration helps us to identify our swatva and through that acquiring swatantrata and swarajya.

Swatva: Innateness of self – the natural acceptance of harmony

Swatantrata: Being self- organized – being in harmony with oneself

Swarajya: Self-expression, self- extension – living in harmony with others

Swatva → Swatantrata → Swarajya

The swatva is already there, intact in each one of us. By being in dialogue with it, we attain swatantrata enabling us to work for swarajya.

Content of Self Exploration

1. **The Desire/Goal:** What is my (human) Desire/ Goal?
2. **Program:** What is my (human) program for fulfilling the desire?

The main focus of self-exploration is myself- the human being. Basically, it should dwell on the following two key questions:

1. What do I really want in life, or what is the goal of human life?
2. How to fulfill it? What is the program to actualize the above?

In short, the above two questions cover the whole domain of human aspirations and human endeavour. Thus, they form the content of self- exploration.

Process of Self Exploration

1. Whatever is being presented is a PROPOSAL.
- Don't assume it to be true immediately, nor reject it without proper exploration.
- Verify it in your own right, on the basis of it being naturally acceptable to you,
 - Not just on the basis of scriptures
 - Not on the basis of equipment/instrument data
 - Not on the basis of the assertion by other human beings.

Therefore, it is essential to carefully ponder over these on your own right. Neither accept these as true immediately nor reject them prematurely without proper exploration.

Don't just accept / reject these only on the basis of the following:

- Because something like this/ different from this, has been mentioned in scriptures,
- Or, because it has been preached/ denied by some great men,
- Or, a large number of people possess such a view / a different view,
- Or it is claimed to have been verified through some physical instrument or, claimed that this is beyond the domain of verifiability by physical instruments.

Then what to do

2. Verify on the basis of your natural acceptance
3. Live accordingly to validate it experientially
 - If the proposal is true in behaviour with human $\xrightarrow{\text{leads to}}$ mutual happiness
 - If the proposal is true in work with rest of the nature $\xrightarrow{\text{leads to}}$ mutual prosperity
4. Results in realization and understanding
5. On having realization and understanding we get
 - a. Assurance
 - b. Satisfaction

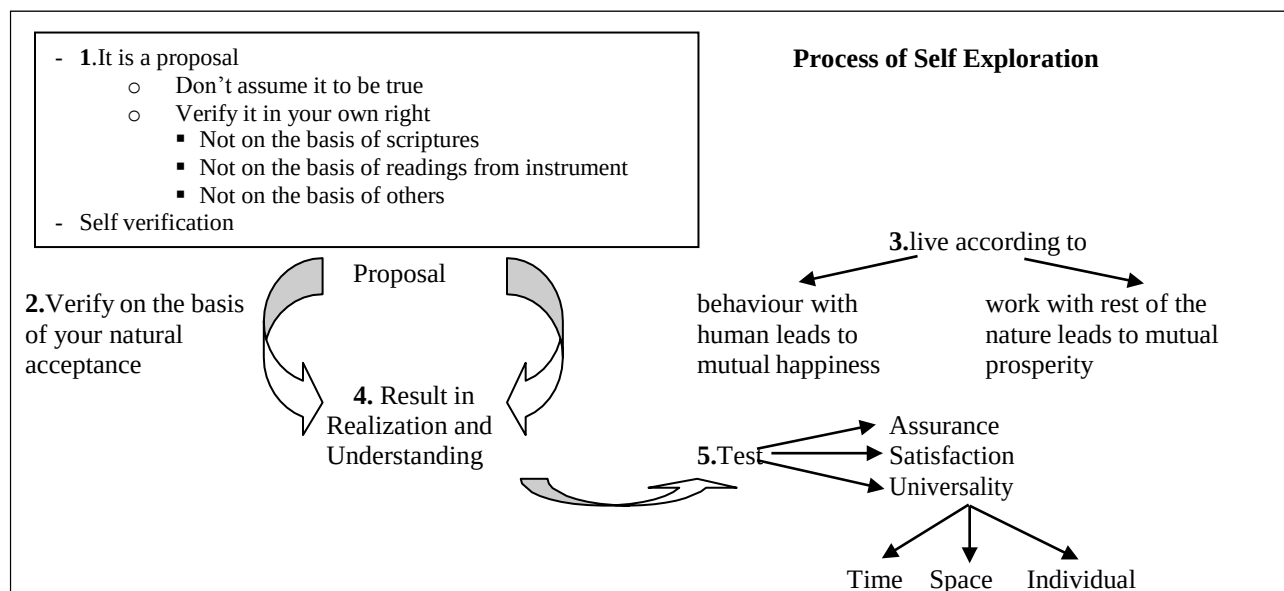
c. Universality (Applies to all time space and individual)

Remember, it is a process of self- exploration, therefore, it has to be authenticated by you alone by means of verification at the level of natural acceptance and experiential validation. The process is shown in the diagram below

Take for **example**: a proposal- ‘respect’ is a value in human relation. When I verify at the level of natural acceptance, I find that it is naturally acceptable to me. Similarly, when I behave with respect, it is mutually fulfilling to me and to the other.

Thus the proposal is ‘True’. If it fails on any of the two tests, it is untrue.

This verification leads to realization of the truthfulness of the proposal and it becomes part and parcel of my understanding. It is reflected in my thoughts and in my behavior.



Mechanism of Self Exploration

If one can explore and understand the self in such a manner that he/she grasps the essence of the self there may never need to be any reason for psychological help at a large stage. The two mechanisms for self exploration may be identified as;

- Natural Acceptance, and
- Experiential Validation.

Natural Acceptance:

Natural acceptance implies unconditional and total acceptance of the self, people and environment. It also refers to the absence of any expectations from others. Once you fully and truly commit yourself on the basis of natural acceptance, you feel a holistic sense of inner harmony, tranquility and fulfillment.

Actually natural acceptance is way to accept the good things naturally. Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it; do not become others.

In other words natural acceptance is process understand yourself first. Try to find out the ego stage. Try to reduce that. Open your eyes and look around. The world is full of good things.

You need to accept the right naturally. Once it starts coming naturally, you will feel that you are actually upgraded yourself and now you are above then the rest of the world. Problems are the part of life and natural acceptance is the answer of that.

Characteristics of natural acceptance:-

1. Does not change with time.
2. Does not depend on places.
3. Does not depend on beliefs or past conditionings.
4. This natural acceptance is 'constantly there' something can refer to. It is telling us what is right.
5. It is same for all of us. It is part and parcel of every human being, it is part of humanness.

Experiential Validation:

Experiential validation is a process that include direct experience with the learning environment and content. It may be regarded as a philosophy and methodology in which the direct experience and focused reflection of the individual helps to increase knowledge, develop skill and clarify values.

We are often told to accept ourselves for who we are. What we know about our self is not through our own opinion but also on how others view us. When our beliefs comes to be true/ validated by some situations, phenomena or outcomes. We may term it as experiential validation.

What is our State Today in self exploration?

Today, we are not oriented enough to evaluate our beliefs or assumptions and we treat them as our personal life. We generally keep them secure in the name of personal life and freedom. We usually become very sticky about them without really verifying them. When these come in conflict, we try hard to search out justifications and make all efforts to defend our own assumptions. In the process, we cheat us ourselves as well as others.

What is the Way Out? What Do We Need To Do?

Realization and Understanding:

As we continue with the process of verification of proposals on the basis of our natural acceptance and test it out in our living, it ultimately results in realization and understanding in us.

The answer we get should be assuring, satisfying and universal. Universal means the answer should be same for everyone. They are invariant with respect to time, space and individual. If the answers we get do not fulfill any of the criteria it means the answer is most likely coming from our past beliefs/conditioning and not from our natural acceptance.

Topic : Basic Human Aspirations – Continuous Happiness and Prosperity

Basic Human aspiration:

We desire for many things in this world, say materialistic needs, respect, recognition, love, trust etc, but in the form of all these we aspire for true and continuous happiness and prosperity.

(i) Happiness

Happiness is a state of mind or feeling characterized by love, satisfaction, pleasure or joy.

Happiness may be described as consisting of positive emotions and positive activities.

Happiness may be defines as being in harmony/ synergy in the state/ situation that I live in . “A state or situation in which I live in , if there is harmony in it then I like to be in that state/ situation. The state of liking is happiness.”

In other words:

- It is a freedom from want and distress
- Consciousness of the good order of things
- Assurance of one’s place in the universe or society
- Inner peace.

Happiness is the state of mind, where we feel good in most of the walk of life.

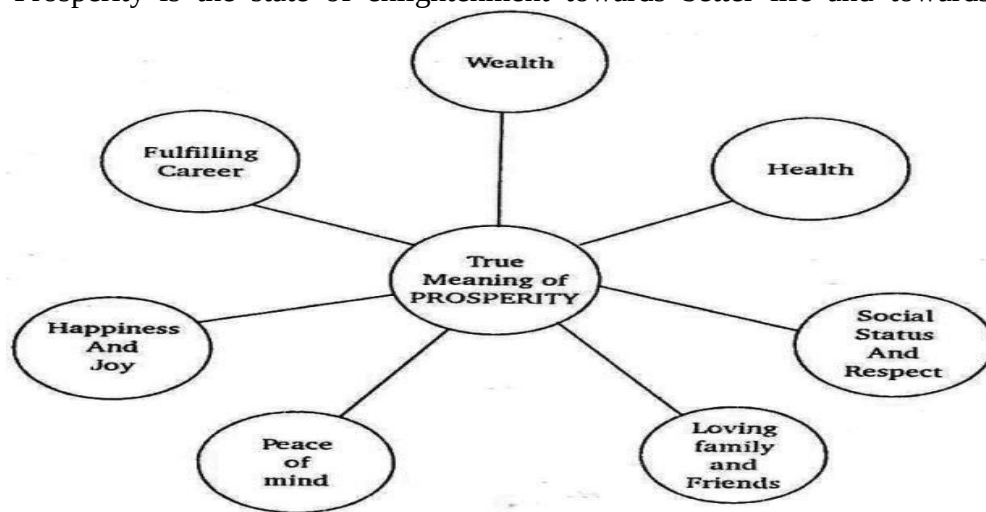
Philosophers and religious thinkers often define happiness in terms of living a good life; or flourishing, rather than simply as an emotion.

(ii) Prosperity

Prosperity is the state of flourishing, thriving, success or good fortune. Prosperity often encompasses wealth but also includes other factors which are independent of wealth to varying degrees, such as happiness and health.

The word means the sum of three aspects – **health, wealth and wisdom.**

Prosperity is the state of enlightenment towards better life and towards the happy society.



Difference between prosperity and wealth

Wealth is a physical thing. It means having money or having a lot of physical facilities or both. **Prosperity** is a feeling of having more than required physical facilities. (Note: all our physical facilities are directly or indirectly depend on nature, the continuity of our prosperity can be ensured only if our production systems are in harmony with the nature. It means using natural resources in a renewable manner and utilizes appropriate technologies so that human needs are satisfied and nature is also enriched).

Presently, as we look around, we find most of the people in the following two categories

To achieve our basic aspiration we need to work for right understanding as the base to which we can work for relationship and then physical facilities. Today we are not working accordingly to this that why we can see that there are two kinds of people in the world.

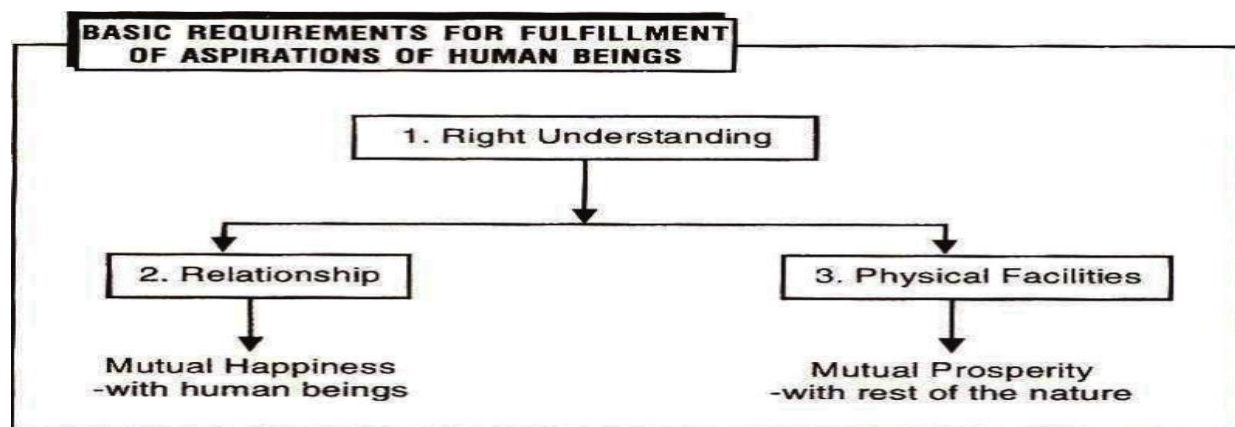
1. Those that do not have physical facilities / wealth and feel unhappy and deprived i.e. SVDD **Sadhan Viheen Dukhi Daridra- Materially deficient , unhappy and deprived**
2. Those that have physical facilities /wealth and feel unhappy and deprived i.e. SSDD **Sadhan Sampan Dukhi Daridra- Meterially affluent ,unhappy and deprived**

But these are states we don't want to be in. We want to move from this to third category i.e.

3. Having physical facilities and feeling happy and prosperous i.e. SSSS **Sadhan Sampann Sukhi Samriddha – Materially adequate , happy and prosperous.**

Presently , as we look around , we found most of the people in the above two categories called SVDD & SSDD , while the natural acceptance of all human being is to be in the categories of SSSS.

Requirements for Fulfilling the Basic Aspirations



The basic requirements for fulfilling the aspirations of every human being are:

- ⇒ **Right Understanding:** This refers to higher order human skills – the need to learn and utilize our intelligence most effectively.
- ⇒ **Good Relationships:** This refers to the interpersonal relationships that a person builds in his or her life – at home, at the workplace and in society.
- ⇒ **Physical Facilities:** This includes the physiological needs of individuals and indicates the necessities as well as the comforts of life.

We can say that these requirements are patterned on the lines of the hierarchy of needs. (Abraham Maslow has given the concept of the hierarchy of needs. According to him there are five needs which can be placed in a hierarchy depending on which needs a person initially strives to fulfill. The lowest needs are the physiological needs. Once these are fulfilled, they are followed by safety and security needs. These are followed by social needs. The next level of needs relates to the person's need for self-esteem. The highest order need relates to the need of self-actualization and will only become important if all the other needs are fulfilled.)

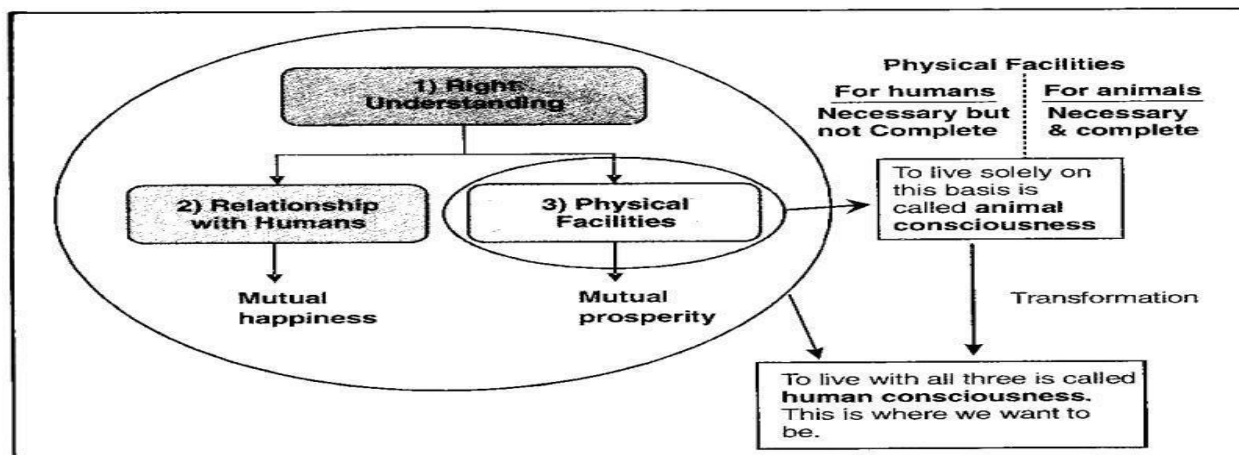
How physical facilities are necessary but not complete for human beings.

Animal Consciousness and Human Consciousness

Giving all priorities to physical facilities only, may be termed as 'Animal consciousness'

- For animal, physical facility is necessary as well as complete – whereas for human beings it is necessary but not complete.
- Working only for physical facilities is living with **Animal Consciousness**.
- Working for right understanding as the first priority followed by relationship and physical facilities implies living with **Human Consciousness**.
- There is a need for transformation from **Animal Consciousness** to **Human Consciousness**. It can be accomplished only by working for right understanding as the first priority.

- This transformation from **Animal Consciousness** to **Human Consciousness** forms the basis for human values and values based living.

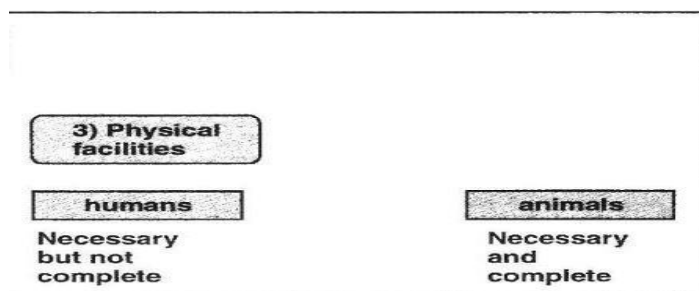


We can verify this by a set of proposals.

“Physical facilities are necessary for human beings.”

“Physical facilities are necessary for human beings and they are necessary for animals.”

“Physical facilities are necessary and complete for animals, while they are necessary but not complete for humans.”



For Animals: Animals need physical things to survive, mainly to take care of their body.

For Humans: While physical facilities are necessary for human beings, they are not complete by themselves to fulfill our needs. Our needs are more than just physical facilities;

Besides physical facilities, we want Relationship:

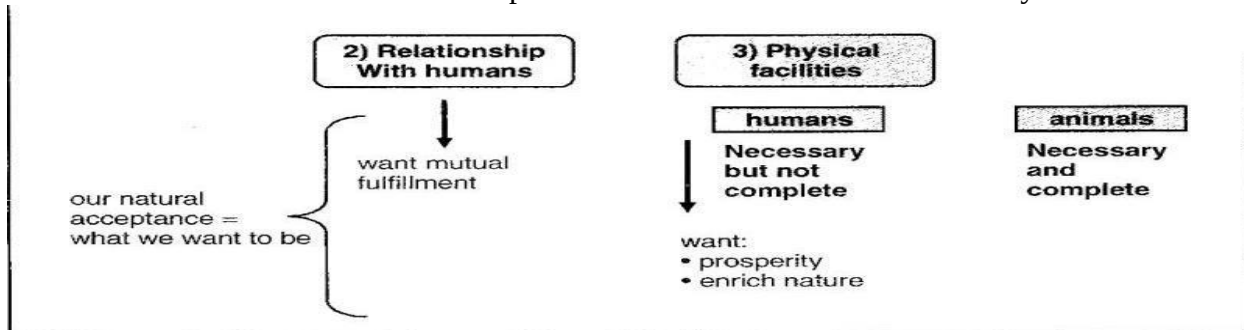
By relationship, we mean the relationship we have with other people, or human beings; father, mother, brother and sisters, our friends, our teachers; we desire good relationships with all of them.

In Relationship we want:

Mutual Fulfillment: If there is a problem in relationship, we feel uneasy, it bothers us. Even if we are interacting with someone, and something we said or did offends them, it makes us uneasy; i.e. we want mutual fulfillment in relationship.

In Physical Facilities we want:

Prosperity in us, Enrichment in Nature: Prosperity means the feeling of having or being able to have more physical facilities than is needed. If we don't have the feeling of prosperity we will exploit others. Similarly as we interact with nature for our various physical needs, either exploit nature or enrich it. But our natural acceptance is that we want to live in harmony with nature.



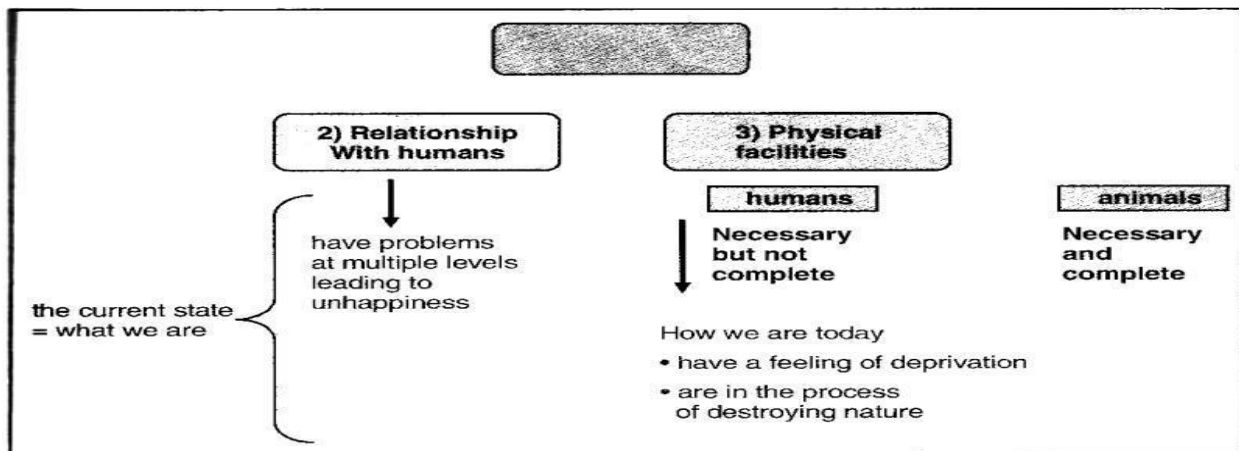
What is Our State Today in Human Aspiration?

In Relationship

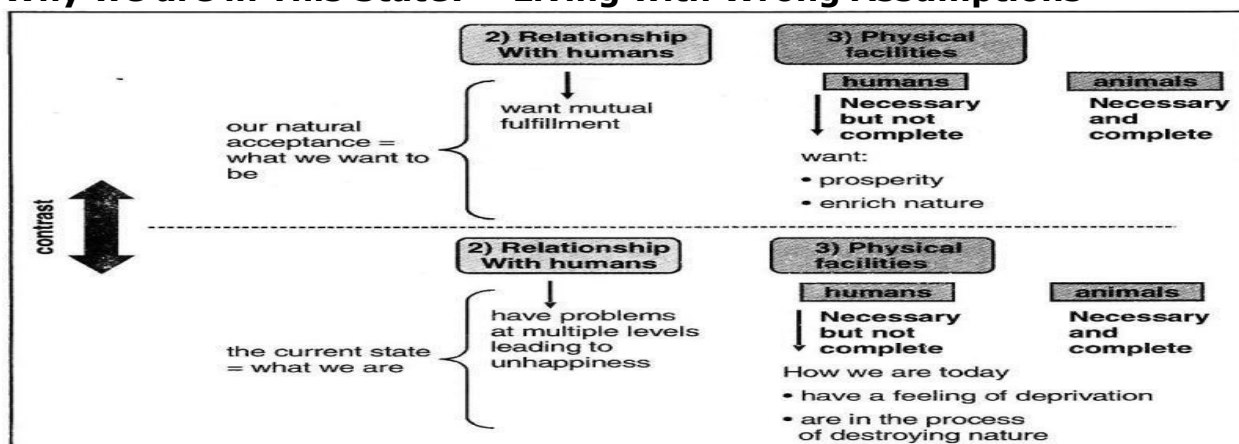
We are unable to have fulfilling relationships all the time: in family, outside family, and as a society – in the world at large.

In Physical Facilities

We want to feel prosperous, but end up working only for accumulation of wealth. We want to enrich nature, but are exploiting it, destroying it.



Why we are in This State? – Living with Wrong Assumptions



What is the Outcome of the Misconception?

- **At the level of individual**– Rising problems of depression, **anxiety**, suicides, stress, insecurity, increasing health problems, lack of confidence and conviction etc.
- **At the level of family**– Breaking up of **joint families**, **mistrust** and disharmony in relationships, divorce, generation gap, dowry deaths, neglect of older people etc.
- **At the level of society**– Growing incidences of **terrorism**, **violence**, communalism, racial and ethnic struggle, corruption, adulteration, sex-crimes exploitation, wars between nations, proliferation of lethal weapons etc.
- **At the level of nature**– **Global warming**, **weather imbalances**, depletion of mineral and energy resources, deforestation, soil degradation etc.

All the problems are a direct outcome of an incorrect understanding, our wrong notion about happiness and prosperity and their continuity – this is an issue for serious exploration. What is the way out?

What is the Solution? – The Need for Right Understanding

In order to resolve the issues in human relationships, we need to *understand* them first, and this would come from '*right understanding of relationship*'.

Similarly in order to be prosperous and to enrich nature, we need to have the '*right understanding*'. The '*right understanding*' will enable us to work out our requirements for physical facilities and hence correctly distinguish the difference between wealth and prosperity. With nature as well, we need to understand the harmony in nature, and how we can complement this harmony.